

DBAs in the Fast Lane

Navigating the Agile World | Lightning Talk

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1. The Old Days of DBA Life

Typical Reality

- Releases were slower.
- Stability over speed.

Typical Position

- End of the delivery chain.
- Final approval step.



DBA Strengths

- Protected integrity.
- Reduced PROD risk.

Core Tension

- Strong for control.
- Weak for frequent change.

2. The New World of Agile

Faster releases

Smaller changes ship more often.

Cross-func teams

DBAs work is closer to dev, test, and ops.

Continuous change

Databases change with the application.

Shared ownership

The database cannot stay in a separate slow lane.

Agile changed the pace. DBAs must change how they contribute.

3. The Agile Workflow



Database work must move through the same delivery flow as application work.

4. How DBAs Integrate into the Workflow

Join Early

- Join design reviews.
- Raise risk early.

Collaborate More

- Work with dev & ops.
- Share responsibility.

Enable Safe Change

- Backward-compatible changes.
- Safer deployment patterns.

Reduce Friction

- Standardize reviews.
- Automate checks.

The goal: safe delivery without making the database a bottleneck.

5. Best Practices for DBAs

- Version-control database changes.
- Prefer small, backward-compatible migrations.
- Automate validation and repeatable checks.
- Plan rollback and recovery.
- Use feedback to improve the next cycle.

Automation plus collaboration are the DBA fast lane.

6. Key Takeaway

Integrate early

Be part of the workflow.

Enable safely

Use automation and safe practices.

Protect what matters

Protect integrity and recoverability.

Agile needs DBAs — just earlier, faster, and closer to the workflow.

Go raibh maith agaibh - Thank you